

Scoring — Faan

Most tables have a **3-faan** minimum to win, with an upper limit of **13 faan**. Faan do not stack with their constituents. Use this guide as a learning aid, not a referee. House rules vary.

Bonus & Situational

Self-Draw – draw the winning tile from the wall	1
Concealed – no claimed discards except the winning tile	1
Win on Last Tile – win on the last tile of the wall	1
Win by Kong – win on a replacement tile after a kong	1
Robbing the Kong – win on a tile used to form a kong	1
Win by Double Kong – win on a tile from a kong, which itself was from a kong	8
Heavenly Hand – dealer wins on their initial 14-tile hand	Limit
Earthly Hand – win on dealer's first discard	Limit

All Hand Patterns

Chicken Hand **0 faan**
Mixed suits, sequences, and triplets



All Triplets **3 faan**
Four triplets/quads. Worth 10 faan if hand is concealed



Mixed Terminals **4 faan**
1s, 9s, and honors only



Small Three Dragons **5 faan**
Two dragon triplets/quads and a dragon pair



Full Flush **7 faan**
All one suit, no honors



All Honors **10 faan**
Only wind and dragon tiles



Big Four Winds **Limit**
A triplet/quad of each wind, plus a pair



Nine Gates **Limit**
One suit of 1112345678999 plus one extra



Flowers & Seasons

No Flowers – no flower or season tiles	1
Seat Flower – flower matching your seat	1
Seat Season – season matching your seat	1
Four Flowers – stacks with seat flower	2
Four Seasons – stacks with seat season	2
Seven Robbing One – seven flowers and seasons; can rob the remaining tile from another player when drawn; auto-win	5
Eight Immortals Crossing Sea – eight flowers and seasons; auto-win	Limit

Honors

Dragons – dragon triplet or quad	1 each
Seat Wind – wind triplet or quad	1
Round Wind – wind triplet or quad	1

All Sequences **1 faan**
Four sequences and a pair



Half Flush **3 faan**
One suit plus honors



Seven Pairs **4 faan**
Seven unique pairs



Small Four Winds **6 faan**
Three wind triplets/quads and a wind pair



Big Three Dragons **8 faan**
A triplet/quad of each dragon



All Terminals **10 faan**
Only 1s and 9s



Thirteen Orphans **Limit**
One of each terminal and honor, plus one duplicate



Four Quads **Limit**
Four kongs plus a pair



Lucky Cat Mahjong

Hong Kong Mahjong Guide

About Us

Lucky Cat Mahjong was founded in NYC by Jorge Yau and Sophia Huang in November 2025 with a simple goal: build a welcoming third-space mahjong community of strong players. Every month, we organize two free community events: a large social gathering open to the public, and a mahjong invitational tournament to recognize and celebrate our most active and deserving members.

We specialize in organizing Hong Kong mahjong events and teaching fundamentals, points, and strategy. Whether you're picking up tiles for the first time or looking to level up, our sessions will give you the skills and confidence to sit down at any table.

How to Get Involved

Support Our Cause

Our mission is to use mahjong as a powerful tool for building social connection and connecting with Asian culture by making it accessible to all. Our core values are **RICE**—Respect, Integrity, Community, and Empathy. Support us by telling your friends, teaching newcomers, buying merch, and bringing mahjong sets to our free community events.

Volunteer

Contact us to volunteer at our events! We always need people to help greet attendees, teach newcomers, bring mahjong sets, and carry out event logistics. Our volunteers get free entry to paid events, and our most dedicated and consistent volunteers will be recognized on our website and get the opportunity to attend exclusive events.



SCAN FOR OUR ONLINE POINTS CALCULATOR

luckycatmahjong.com

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Setting Up & Basic Play

The Objective

Be the first to complete **four melds and one pair** (14 tiles), drawing from the wall or claiming discards. The minimum hand value to win is 3 faan.

The Tiles

Characters



Circles



Bamboos



Honors



Flowers & Seasons



1. Build the Walls

Flip all 144 tiles face down and shuffle them. Builds four walls of **18 tiles long and 2 tiles high** (36 tiles each). Then push the walls closer together into a square.

2. Roll the Dice for the Break

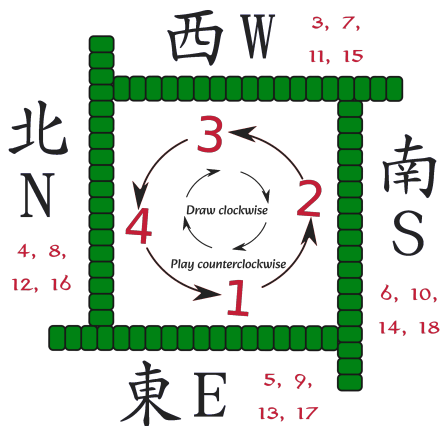
The dealer (East) rolls three dice. Sum the total and go counter-clockwise that many times around the walls starting with East as 1 to determine which wall to break. Then count the same dice total from that wall going clockwise to make the break.

3. Deal the Tiles

Deal tiles in groups of four going counter-clockwise, while drawing clockwise until everyone has **13 tiles** and the dealer has **14 tiles**. Everyone draws replacement tiles from the end of the wall for revealing bonus tiles, starting with the dealer. The dealer starts by discarding a tile.

4. The Flow of Play

Take turns playing counter-clockwise (East → South → West → North). Draw clockwise from the wall. Between turns you may claim a discarded tile instead of drawing to complete a meld by exposing it. End your turn by discarding a tile.



Core Concepts

What Is a Meld?

A **meld** is a legal set of tiles that counts toward your winning hand. In Hong Kong mahjong you typically need **four melds plus one pair**. Melds can stay hidden in your hand (concealed) or be laid face-up after you claim a discarded tile (exposed).

The Melds



Chi Sequence

Three tiles in a consecutive run of one suit (e.g. 2-3-4 Characters). Only claimable from the player on your left.



Pung Triplet

Three identical tiles. You may claim a matching discard from any player. Has priority over a chi.



Kong Quad

Four identical tiles. Claim a discard to make an exposed kong, or declare a concealed kong or add it to an exposed meld when you draw the fourth yourself. After either, draw a replacement tile from the end of the wall. Has priority over a pung.



Pair The Eyes

Two identical tiles that complete the hand. Every winning hand needs exactly one pair.

Winning on the Last Tile

You can win by **self-drawing** the last tile you need from the wall, or by **claiming** that tile from anyone's discard. A win has the highest priority over chi, pung, and kong. If more than one player needs the same discard to win, the next player in the turn order wins.

Concealed vs. Exposed

A hand is **concealed** if you never claim a discard tile (except the winning tile). Concealed hands and self-draws earn bonus faan. Claiming discards **exposes** those melds face-up on the table for everyone to see.

Flowers & Seasons

Eight **bonus tiles**. They never form melds and are not part of your hand. Set them aside when drawn and take a replacement tile from the end of the wall.



Plum



Orchid



Chrysanthemum



Bamboo



Spring



Summer



Autumn



Winter